

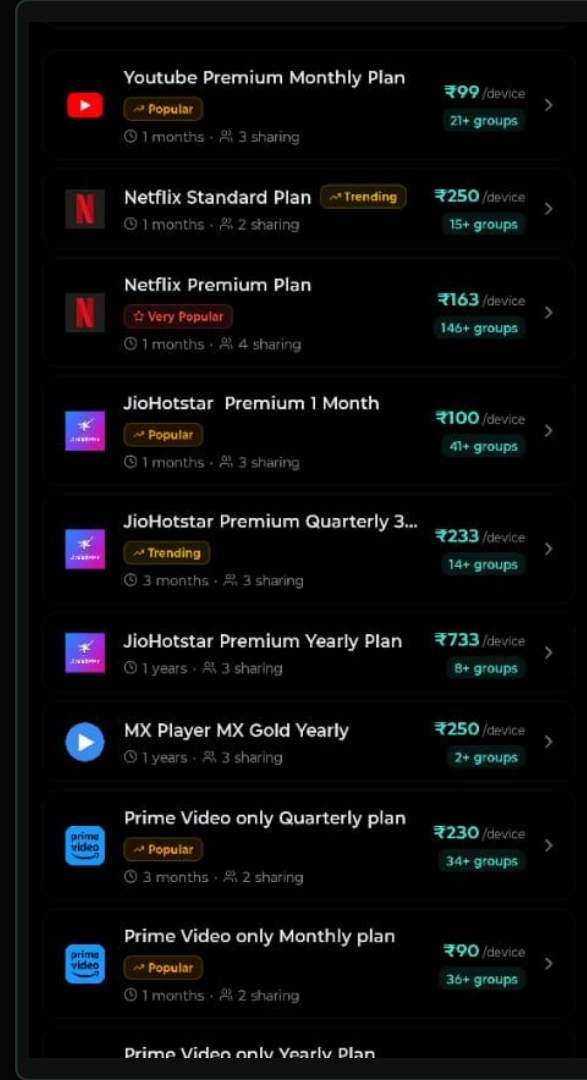
PRODUCT INTERN ASSIGNMENT · 2026

Subspace.money

Product Teardown

Five sharpest feedbacks across GTM, Competition, Features, UX & Collaborations — written from actually using the app.

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■ APPROACH

I used the app end-to-end, then tore it down

Every observation here is **firsthand and screenshot-backed**. I signed up, browsed the marketplace, **paid real money to join a YouTube Premium group**, listed a subscription as an admin, **messaged five different group admins**, and went through checkout, wallet and chat. Competitor and reliability context is cross-checked against public sources.

1

GTM & ICP

2

Competitor
Analysis

3

Features /
Services

4

UX

5

Potential
Collaborations

■ Format for each: **Observed** → **Why it matters** → **Ship instead**

The home screen serves four different people

👁 OBSERVED

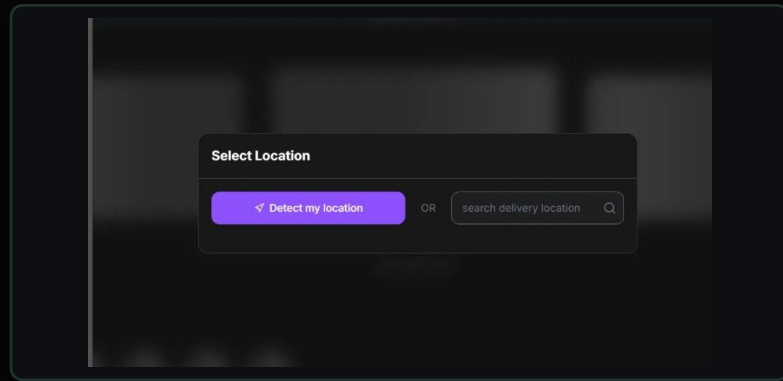
First-time users hit a "search delivery location" gate — odd for a subscription-sharing app. Get past it and the home presents four unrelated jobs: Events, Add Subscriptions, Sell Products, and bill payments. In that order.

⚠ WHY IT MATTERS

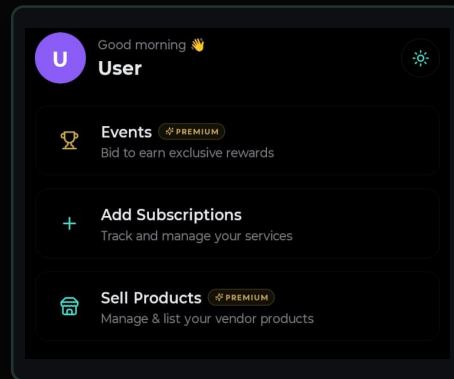
No single user needs all four. The gate alone kills activation — most people don't know what delivery location has to do with splitting a YouTube sub. The product is trying to be everything, so it reads as nothing.

➔ SHIP INSTEAD

Pick one ICP — the person splitting a subscription — and build the home around them. Run location silently, surface it only for rentals. Move Events, Sell Products and bills to a secondary tab.



Location gate + a four-in-one home



Right advantages, wrong moment

👁 OBSERVED

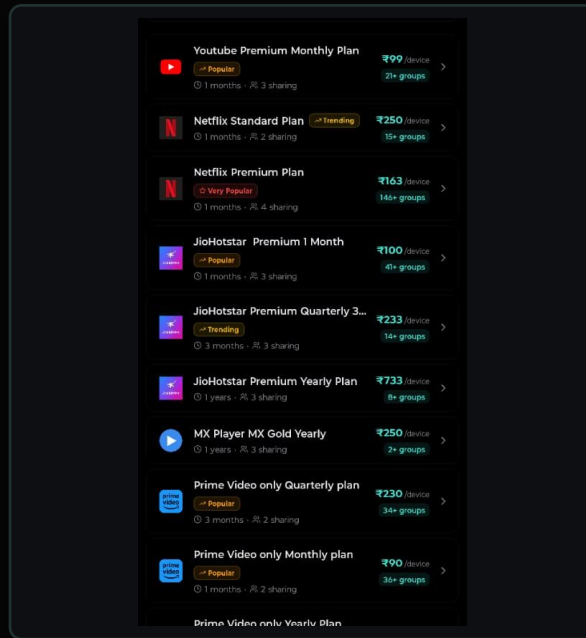
The real rival isn't another app — it's the free WhatsApp + UPI split.
Subspace's edges (refunds, rated admins) appear only after you open a listing.

⚠ WHY IT MATTERS

A skeptic weighing "free split vs this" needs reasons to trust up front. Shown only after exploring, they never reach those most likely to leave.

➡ SHIP INSTEAD

Move the trust signals to the home hero and first-run, before exploration — and name the category so the right users can even find it.



Tracxn even files it beside chit-fund apps

No India app rival — three buckets shape the market

GLOBAL P2P MARKETPLACES

Spliit · Sharesub · GoSplit

France-origin, EU-focused

- P2P: admins list slots, buyers join, platform mediates
- ~5% + flat fee per renewal (per published pricing)
- Admin KYC + invoice checks + SLA buyer protection
- Legality tier declared per service

No India operations; no INR pricing

CREDENTIAL RESELLERS

GamsGo-type platforms

Reportedly China-based; per 3rd-party reviews

- Resells foreign login credentials — not true sharing
- Cheapest price point; legally grey (ToS violation)
- High account block / dropout risk
- No mediation, community, or buyer protection

Different model — access, not membership

INDIA INFORMAL

WhatsApp + UPI + Forums

TechnoFino, Reddit, social circles

- Zero platform fee — just split the cost
- Trust from social connections only
- No dispute resolution or refund protection
- Dominant channel; enormous but fragmented

Hard to find admins outside your network

Subspace is the only formalized India-native marketplace — category wide open

OTT platforms tightening sharing policies = structural risk and partnership opportunity

Same question, five answers

OBSERVED

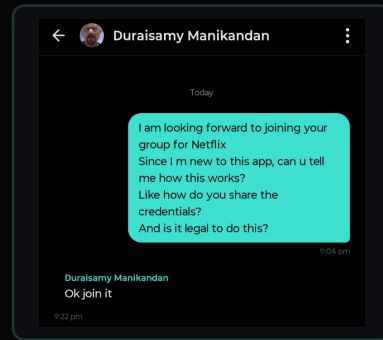
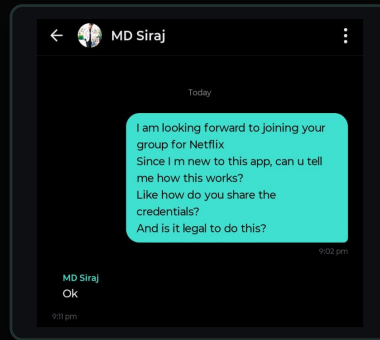
I asked five admins the same thing — how does this work, are credentials shared, is it legal? Four Netflix admins: silence, "hii", "Ok", "Ok join it."

WHY IT MATTERS

The core transaction is explained by no one but the admin — and most don't. Trust is pure luck. One even asked me to "rate 5 star" right after.

SHIP INSTEAD

Auto-post a platform-written "How this group works" card as the first message in every room. Don't outsource trust to admin goodwill.



Four Netflix admins — same question, no real answer

Access is handed over differently each time

👁 OBSERVED

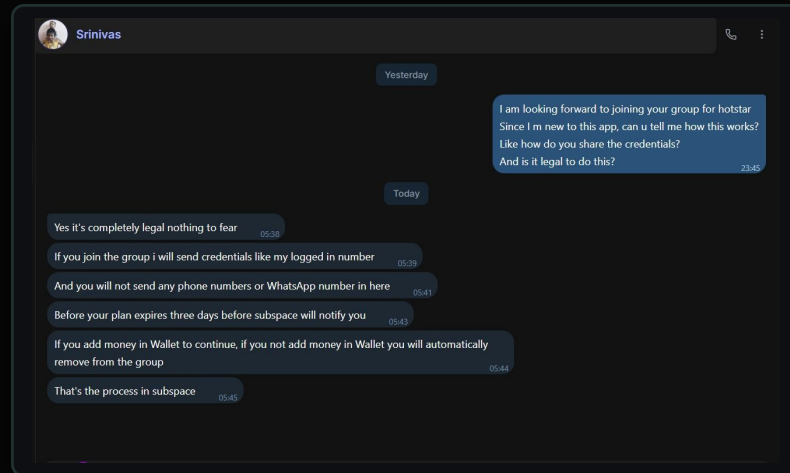
YouTube came as an official Google family invite. Hotstar (shown) shares a logged-in number + OTP. Netflix was never explained — none shown before paying.

⚠ WHY IT MATTERS

These methods differ wildly in security and legality, yet look identical in the marketplace. You can't tell a clean invite from a shared password until after paying.

➡ SHIP INSTEAD

Label delivery method + legality on every listing before checkout. For Netflix, use its paid Extra-Member feature — or say so plainly.



The one admin who explained — Hotstar, via shared login + OTP

The price you see isn't what you pay

👁 OBSERVED

Listings and "Your Subscriptions" show ₹99 for YouTube Premium. The +5% fee appears only at final checkout — ₹99 quietly becomes ₹103.95.

⚠ WHY IT MATTERS

For a product that sells "save money," surfacing the fee only at the last step is drip pricing — it dents the savings story exactly as you commit.

➔ SHIP INSTEAD

Show the all-in price (including the 5% fee) on listings and browse cards, not just at checkout. One honest number up front beats a moving one.

	Monthly Plan Youtube Premium	₹99 per Device
Group Admin: Anupam		2/3 users
Next payment will be charged on: Jun 25, 2026		
Billing Details		
Item Price		₹99
Fee (5%)		+ ₹4.95
Total Wallet Balance (₹100.00)		- ₹100.00
Net Payable		₹3.95

₹99 advertised → ₹103.95 paid

The chat blanks on every refresh

👁 OBSERVED

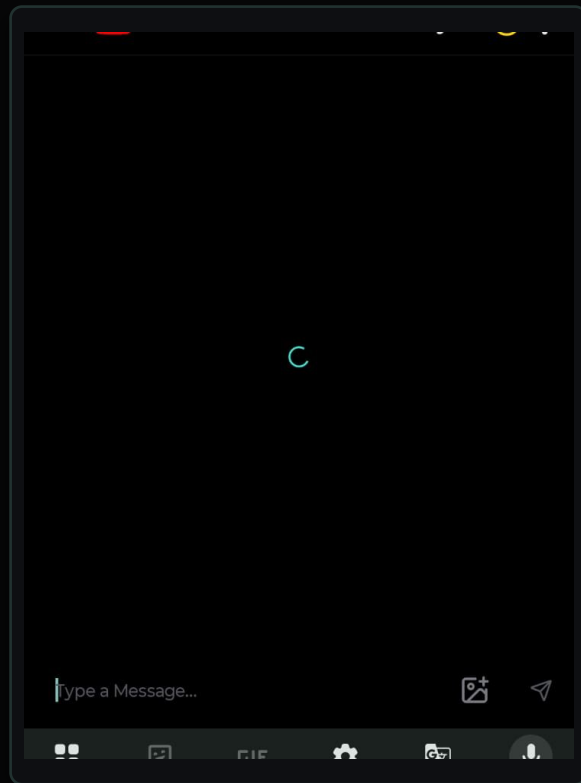
The group chat periodically goes fully black with a lone spinner — the app appears to poll for new messages by wiping and reloading the view each time.

⚠ WHY IT MATTERS

In the chat where you're waiting for credentials, a black screen on each poll reads as a crash. This isn't a one-time load problem — it recurs throughout the session.

➔ SHIP INSTEAD

Render cached messages behind a skeleton loader. Poll in the background and surface new content without ever blanking the view; add an unread badge on the Chat tab.



A partnership shelf, empty

👁 OBSERVED

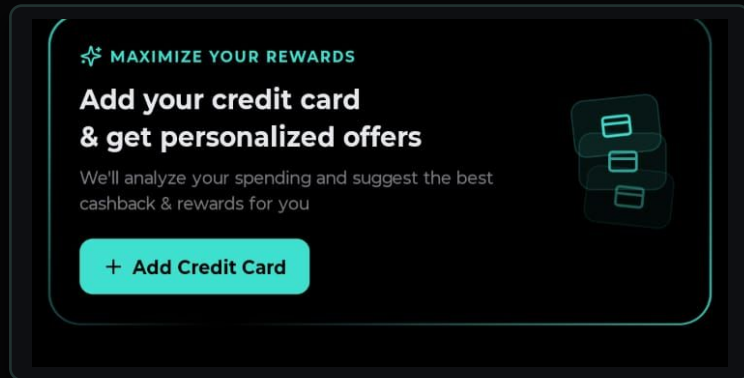
Prime home space goes to "Add your credit card & get personalized offers."
Tap it: no named cards, no rates, no offers — built before partnerships exist.

⚠ WHY IT MATTERS

It asks for card data for a vague promise and spends the home screen on nothing — while its volume makes it attractive to partners it hasn't signed.

➔ SHIP INSTEAD

(1) Co-branded cashback at named rates on popular cards. (2) Become an official OTT reseller — YouTube already works this way. Until offers exist, drop it.



Card cashback

named rates on subs

OTT reseller

grey area → moat

The shelf is built — it just needs real partners.

Four partnership tracks — each a real revenue line

OTT PARTNERSHIP

Become the official distribution layer

YouTube's family invite proves the model. Replicate with other OTTs — earn margin on every seat sold through an official, legal channel rather than a grey one.

Revenue: reseller margin per seat

CARD CASHBACK

Name the offers already on the home screen

Cards targeting young Indians (e.g. HDFC Millennia) already offer OTT cashback. Subspace brings user volume; banks bring named, auditable rates — specific offers worth showing.

Revenue: referral fee per card acquired

TELECOM OVERFLOW

The unbundled OTT layer for Jio and Airtel

Airtel Xstream and Jio bundle some OTTs in postpaid plans — not all. Subspace fills the gap, or becomes a co-marketed add-on on prepaid recharge packs for the rest.

Revenue: distribution fee / revenue share

B2B / INSTITUTIONAL

Team subscriptions for offices and campuses

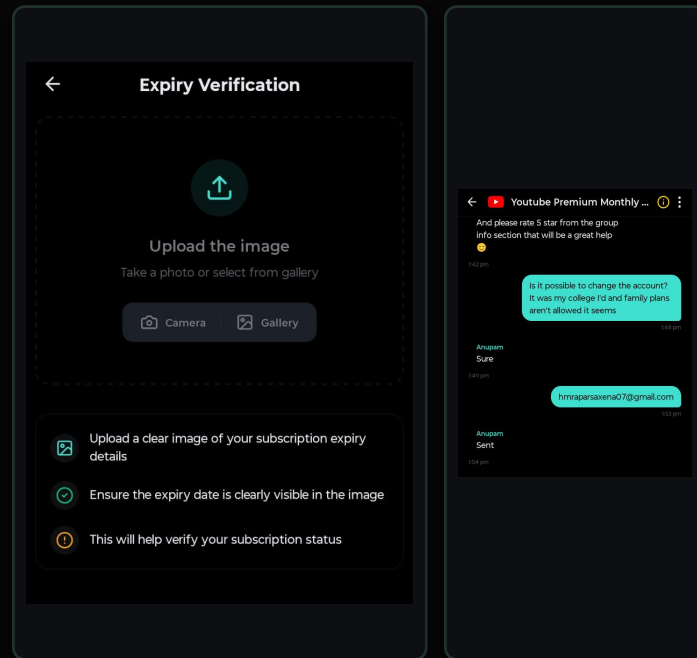
Companies already pay for Canva, M365, Notion. A team-admin mode makes Subspace a B2B product — different ICP from the current consumer base, much higher LTV per account.

Revenue: B2B per-seat SaaS margin

Near-term: card cashback · Medium-term: OTT + telecom · Longer-term: B2B / institutional

What Subspace gets right

- ✓ **Partial refund on mid-cycle joins**
Join late and you're billed only for the days you use. Genuinely fair design.
- ✓ **Supply-side verification**
Admins upload proof of an active plan + expiry before a group can go public.
- ✓ **Clean delivery where allowed**
YouTube Premium arrived as an official Google family invite — fully compliant.
- ✓ **Renewal safety net**
Subspace warns 3 days before expiry; a lapse simply removes you from the group.



Verification + clean invite

WHERE TO FOCUS FIRST

Three things I'd ship first

1

Put trust before the payment

Label delivery method, legality and the 5% fee on the listing — not buried in checkout. A buyer should know exactly what they're getting before money changes hands.

COVERS

Features · UX

Low effort — copy and UI placement

2

Standardize what admins say and do

Auto-post a platform-written room card the moment a member joins. Pair it with ratings tied to response quality — not coached star requests.

COVERS

Features

Medium effort — template tooling + ratings

3

Earn every surface on the home screen

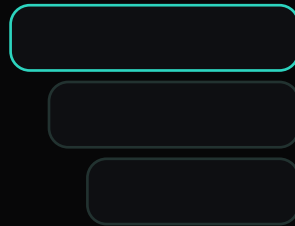
Remove unfinished bets (Events, Sell Products, empty card shelf) until they deliver real value. Give the home one job: help someone find a group and join.

COVERS

GTM · Collaborations

Low effort — product decisions only

■ All three are policy and UX calls, not new infrastructure — the gap between the model working and the model being trusted.



The model works. The gaps are trust, timing and focus.

Subspace's sharing engine genuinely saves money — I used it. What holds it back isn't missing features; it's that the product asks for trust, money and attention before it earns them. Fix those three and it starts keeping the users who currently leave.